

There is, in the Harleian manuscripts, a paper addressed to Sir Francis Bacon, which contains the King's sentiments and reasons for coming to this resolution, as well as a tacit confession, that hitherto, neither the King nor his Privy Council had made any satisfactory progress in the improvement of the disrelished reports. Their great author, in his replies, evidently scorned the ignorance of his critics.

In this paper, probably written about the 10th of October, 1616, the King commenced by laying down certain rules for the further progress of this affair, and to this end told his servants "that although the discharging and removing of his Majesty's officers and servants, as well as the choice and advancement of men to place, be no council chamber matters, but belong to his Majesty's princely will and secret judgment, yet his Majesty will do his council this honour, that in his resolutions of that kind his council shall know them first before others, and shall know them, accompanied by their causes, making, as it were, a private manifesto, or revealing of himself to them without parables.

"Then to have the report of the Lords, touching the business of the Lord Coke, and the last order of the Council read.

* No. 7006.